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10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A OBSERVABILITY · PRACTICE WORKSHEET

CONCEPTUAL SERIES

Datadog

Name: ______________________ Cohort/Batch: ______________________ Date: ______________ Score: ______

DATADOG PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Observability

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is Datadog and what problem in Observability does it solve? *Threat Model*

Q2 What are the core components or concepts in Datadog? *Architecture*

Q3 How does Datadog compare to its main alternatives? *Configuration*

Q4 How do you get started with Datadog for a new project? *Hardening*

Q5 What configuration options most affect Datadog's behavior in production? *SSO / IdP*

Q6 How does Datadog handle reliability and high availability? *Observability*

Q7 What observability does Datadog provide out of the box? *Lifecycle*

Q8 What are common performance bottlenecks in Datadog? *Compliance*

Q9 What security best practices apply when running Datadog? *Testing*

Q10 What mistakes do teams commonly make when adopting Datadog? *Tuning*

SOLUTIONS GUIDE
Datadog

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 Datadog is a tool or platform that

Mitigation

Datadog is a tool or platform that automates or simplifies a specific concern in the Observability domain, reducing manual effort and operational complexity for engineering teams.

A2 Datadog has key building blocks that work

Primitives

Datadog has key building blocks that work together: a configuration layer defines intent, a runtime layer enforces it, and an API or CLI layer allows operators to manage and observe the system.

A3 Datadog trades off simplicity against feature richness

Hardening

Datadog trades off simplicity against feature richness differently than its alternatives. Choose Datadog when its specific strengths performance, ecosystem, or ease of use align with your team's primary constraints.

A4 Install Datadog via its package manager or

Gotchas

Install Datadog via its package manager or binary release. Follow the quickstart to initialize a project, configure the minimal required settings, and run the default command to verify the setup works end-to-end.

A5 Production-critical settings typically include concurrency

Federation

Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels. Review the official production hardening guide before deploying.

A6 Datadog provides HA through leader election, replication,

Observability

Datadog provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless horizontal scaling. Deploy at least two instances across availability zones and configure health checks for automatic failover.

A7 Datadog exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in

Automation

Datadog exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard), structured logs, and optionally distributed traces. Define SLOs on the key metrics and alert before users are affected.

A8 Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured

Governance

Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools, large payload sizes, insufficient worker threads, or missing caches. Profile with built-in diagnostics before optimizing.

A9 Run Datadog with the principle of least

Assessment

Run Datadog with the principle of least privilege, enable TLS for all communication, use a secrets manager for credentials, and keep the software patched to the latest stable release.

A10 Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and

Optimization

Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error, using default configurations in production, lacking a runbook for operational issues, and not testing failover scenarios.